about what seems to be a move to try and fracture the mandate in the Valley while consolidating the mandate in Jammu.

● **MEHBOOBA MUFTI:** For us, the resolution of the Kashmir issue is the priority and the most important thing. Then come the problems of unemployment, inflation, the environment and drug addiction. We have the highest rate of unemployment—one third of the youth—and there are hardly any avenues of employment except government jobs. The government has been dismissing people from government jobs by marking them as militant-affiliated for no rhyme or reason and then throwing them out.

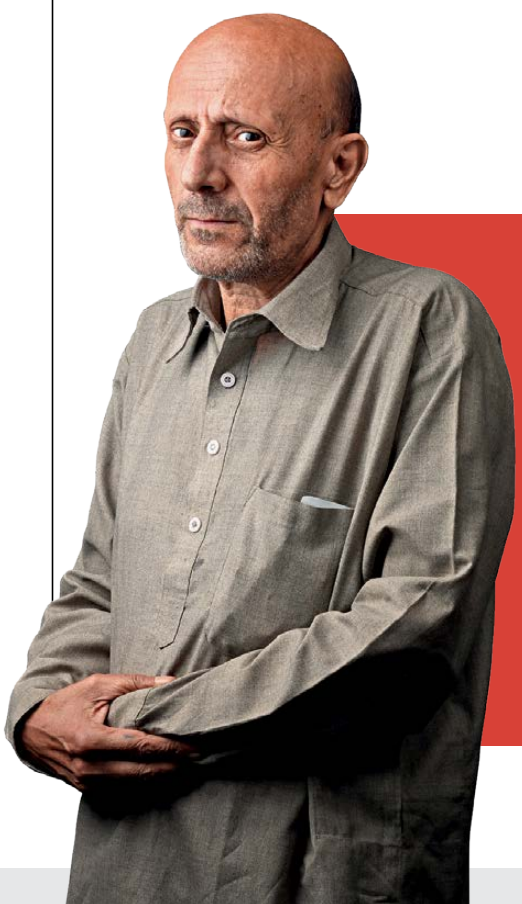
● **JITENDRA SINGH:** Regardless of whatever the votaries of Article 370 say, Kashmiri citizens, particularly the youth who are highly aspirational, would not like to miss the bus driven by PM Modi that has made India one of the most attractive destinations for avenues of employment in the past 10 years. Also, the locals who were dependent largely on tourism had to virtually starve before that. For them, it is a great relief to have 2.5 crore tourists coming here and they would like that to continue.



"Article 370 is not the be-all and end-all of our campaign. It also deals with all the day-to-day issues like basic governance"

— OMAR ABDULLAH

● **TARIQ HAMEED KARRA** It's not only about our development or for our lanes and drains. It is about the restoration of statehood along with guarantees for our land and employment. It is for the restoration of our lost dignity that we have been robbed of using a very undemocratic and unconstitutional way. It is for the restoration of the self-respect of the people of Jammu and Kashmir.



"We want permanent peace, not the peace of the graveyard. I want to appeal to the PM: solve the Kashmir issue and you'll become Vishwaguru"

— ENGINEER RASHID

● **ENGINEER RASHID:** Kashmir is the biggest issue, not Atal tunnels and other projects. We want permanent peace, not the peace of the graveyard. I want to appeal to the NDA government and the PM, for god's sake, listen to the voice of your conscience. One lakh people have already died. Everybody is suffering. If you solve the Kashmir issue, you would become Vishwaguru.

● **SAJAD LONE:** There's a lot of anger. People have been humiliated continuously for the past five years. They have lost their voices. They don't have their own representatives. So, issues will be centred around this emotion and sentiment.

● **ALTAF BUKHARI:** Give Kashmir the rights that it deserves under the Constitution of India. We want to protect our identity, culture, lands and jobs—give us the choices that every state has in the country. Give us an opportunity to live like normal Indians. The big issue in this election is to give a general amnesty to those who have been arrested and put into jail except those accused of heinous crimes.

● **RAVINDER RAINA** Development, justice, transparency and honesty. Those who are talking of Pakistan, self-rule and terrorism are now forced to talk of development, including building schools and roads. ■